

Safer Recruitment & DBS Policy

Ensuring everyone working with our young people is safe to do so

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE • Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or safeguarding incident)

1. Statement of Intent

L-Fit Pathways is committed to safer recruitment practice at every stage of employing or engaging staff and volunteers, to ensure that only suitable individuals work with the young people in our care.

2. Legal Framework

- Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026, Part 3 (Safer Recruitment)
- Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006
- Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974 (Exceptions Order 1975, as amended)
- Childcare (Disqualification) and Childcare (Early Years Provision Free of Charge) (Extended Entitlement) (Amendment) Regulations, where applicable

3. Recruitment Process

All appointments, whether paid staff, sessional workers or volunteers, follow the same core safer recruitment process:

- A clear role description outlining safeguarding responsibilities
- Application requiring full employment/education history with explanation of any gaps
- At least two references, including the most recent employer, sought directly and independently verified — never provided by the candidate as an open letter
- Face-to-face (or video) interview including specific safeguarding-focused questions
- Verification of identity, right to work, and relevant qualifications
- An Enhanced DBS check (including barred list check where the role involves regulated activity) obtained before any unsupervised contact with young people
- A structured induction covering this Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy before independent work with young people begins

4. Volunteers

Following KCSIE 2026, all volunteers working with young people at L-Fit Pathways — including short-term and occasional volunteers — require an Enhanced DBS check; the previous 'supervision exemption' no longer applies. No volunteer works unsupervised with a young person until their DBS check has been received and reviewed by a DSL.

5. Single Central Record

L-Fit Pathways maintains a Single Central Record (SCR) of all staff and volunteers, recording: identity checks, DBS certificate number and date, barred list check status, references obtained, and qualification checks. The SCR is maintained by the Co-Directors and reviewed at each policy review.

6. Ongoing Checks

Staff and volunteers are encouraged to subscribe to the DBS Update Service. Where this is not in place, a renewed Enhanced DBS check is obtained every 3 years, with an annual self-declaration of any change in circumstances in the intervening years.

7. Roles & Responsibilities

Adam Byrne and Craig Lloyd, as Co-Directors and DSLs, are jointly responsible for ensuring this policy is followed for every appointment and for maintaining the Single Central Record.

8. Monitoring & Review

This policy is reviewed annually or following any change to DBS/safer recruitment legislation or guidance.

Policy adopted on: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027